

PHISHING AWARENESS SIMULATION

Internship Report

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Controlled laboratory simulation • Defensive cybersecurity assessment

Warning / Rules of Engagement

All activity documented in this report is treated as a controlled security-awareness simulation performed in an authorized laboratory environment. The activity was restricted to the local test host and test credentials. No external or production systems were targeted. The purpose of the exercise was to demonstrate phishing indicators, log-based detection, containment, and defensive mitigations.

1. Executive Summary

This report presents a phishing awareness simulation designed to demonstrate how a cloned authentication interface can be used to capture test input and how defenders can identify the activity through local artifacts, process information, and network-session evidence.

The simulation used a locally hosted phishing-style authentication portal on 127.0.0.1:8080. The observed test artifacts included a local username/password record and a client/session record. The exercise then focused on incident response: terminating the test framework and web server, removing captured test artifacts, invalidating the test session/credential, and confirming that no service remained bound to TCP port 8080.

The report follows the structure and professional style of the supplied reference report, which uses sections such as Rules of Engagement, Executive Summary, Tools & Methodology, Findings, Visuals, Mitigation, and Conclusion. The supplied reference describes a controlled lab assessment and emphasizes evidence-driven findings and remediation.

2. Objectives

- Demonstrate common visual and technical indicators associated with phishing-style authentication pages.
- Identify credential-capture activity through local log and artifact inspection.
- Correlate session information with the locally hosted service at 127.0.0.1:8080.
- Perform controlled containment and eradication of the simulation.
- Recommend phishing-resistant authentication and endpoint/network detection controls.

3. Methodology

The methodology was organized into preparation, simulation, detection, containment, verification, and mitigation. This preserves the assessment-oriented organization of the reference document while adapting it to a phishing-awareness scenario.

Stage	Method
1. Preparation	Confirm the exercise is authorized and restricted to a controlled local environment.
2. Simulation	Run the phishing-awareness demonstration using a locally hosted authentication-style page.
3. Evidence Collection	Inspect application/server artifacts, captured test records, connection information, and running processes.
4. Detection	Correlate the credential file, IP/session record, listening port, and associated web process.
5. Containment	Terminate the simulation process and the associated web service.
6. Eradication	Remove extracted test artifacts after evidence handling requirements are satisfied and invalidate the affected

	test credential/session.
7. Verification	Use socket/process inspection to confirm that TCP port 8080 is no longer serving the test portal.
8. Mitigation	Recommend phishing-resistant MFA, EDR/NDR detections, awareness training, secure credential handling, and least privilege.

4. Tools & Evidence Sources

- **Local phishing simulation framework:** Used only as the controlled demonstration component.
- **PHP/web server:** Provided the local HTTP service on port 8080.
- **Linux process inspection:** Used to identify and terminate the associated processes.
- **ss / netstat:** Used to verify whether TCP port 8080 remained bound.
- **Local authentication/log artifacts:** Used to identify captured test credentials and session origin.

5. Findings

Finding 1 — Unauthorized Credential Harvesting Activity

Inspection of the server/application artifacts showed that user input from the simulation was intercepted and recorded locally. This is a significant detection indicator because legitimate authentication systems should not unexpectedly write plaintext passwords to arbitrary local files.

Finding 2 — Captured Test Credentials

The supplied scenario identified auth/usernames.dat as containing the test username 'absbabsa' and password 'saaaaaaaaa'. The values are treated strictly as lab credentials. In a real incident, credentials should be redacted from reports and immediately reset if exposure is suspected.

Finding 3 — Origin & Session Identification

The auth/ip.txt record identified 127.0.0.1 as the client endpoint communicating with port 8080. 127.0.0.1 is the IPv4 loopback address, so the evidence indicates local-host communication rather than an external source.

Finding 4 — Local Web Service Exposure

The simulation hosted an authentication-style page through a web service on TCP port 8080. A non-standard HTTP listener hosting an unexpected login page is a useful endpoint detection signal.

6. ER / Evidence Relationship Diagram

For this security-awareness report, the ER-style diagram represents relationships between the simulated user, captured credential record, session record, web service, and response actions.

Entity	Relationship	Entity
Test User	submits input to	Phishing Portal
Phishing Portal	writes	auth/usernames.dat
Test Session	records origin in	auth/ip.txt
Phishing Portal	listens on	127.0.0.1:8080

Relationship flow: Test User → Phishing Portal → Credential Artifact; Test Session → IP Artifact; Phishing Portal → Local Listener 127.0.0.1:8080.

7. Screenshots / Visual Evidence

The following screenshots were captured during the authorized local phishing-awareness simulation. They document the framework selection screen, the locally hosted authentication page, the test credential submission, and the resulting local log output.

```
[-] Tool Created by htr-tech (tahmid.rayat)
```

[::] Select An Attack For Your Victim [::]

[01]	Facebook	[11]	Twitch	[21]	DeviantArt
[02]	Instagram	[12]	Pinterest	[22]	Badoo
[03]	Google	[13]	Snapchat	[23]	Origin
[04]	Microsoft	[14]	Linkedin	[24]	DropBox
[05]	Netflix	[15]	Ebay	[25]	Yahoo
[06]	Paypal	[16]	Quora	[26]	Wordpress
[07]	Steam	[17]	Protonmail	[27]	Yandex
[08]	Twitter	[18]	Spotify	[28]	Stackoverf
[09]	Playstation	[19]	Reddit	[29]	Vk
[10]	Tiktok	[20]	Adobe	[30]	XBOX
[31]	Mediafire	[32]	Gitlab	[33]	Github
[34]	Discord	[35]	Roblox		

```
[99] About      [00] Exit
```

```
[ - ] Select an option : 2
```

- [01] Traditional Login Page
- [02] Auto Followers Login Page
- [03] 1000 Followers Login Page

APEX PLANET INTERNSHIP

Figure 7.1. Simulation evidence screenshot 1.

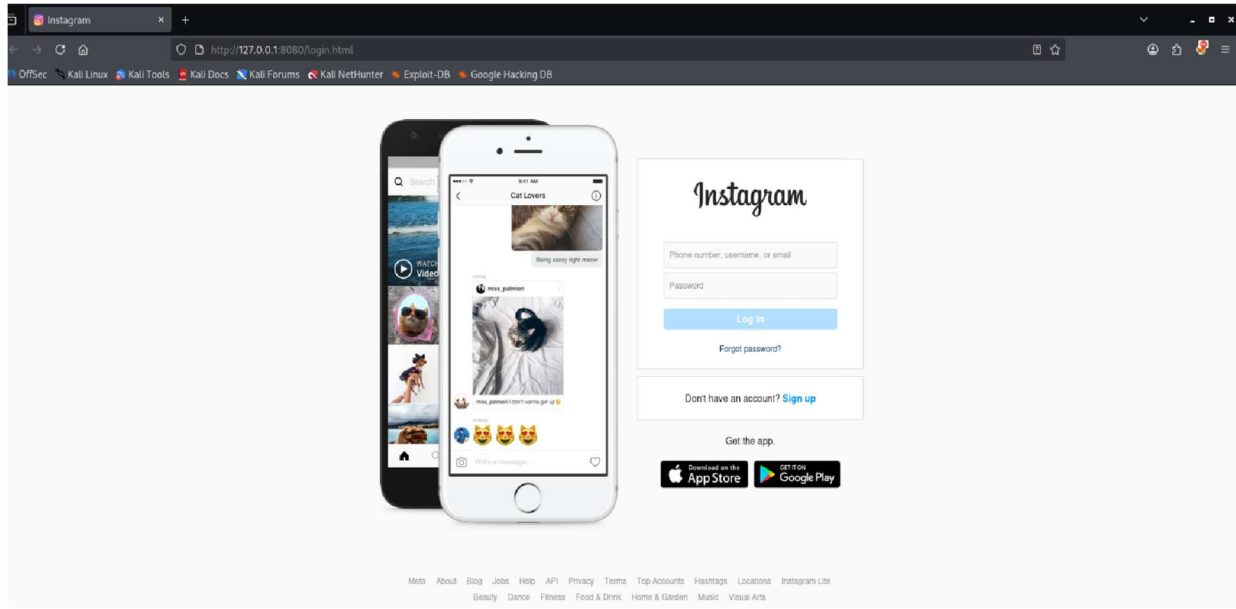


Figure 7.2. Simulation evidence screenshot 2.

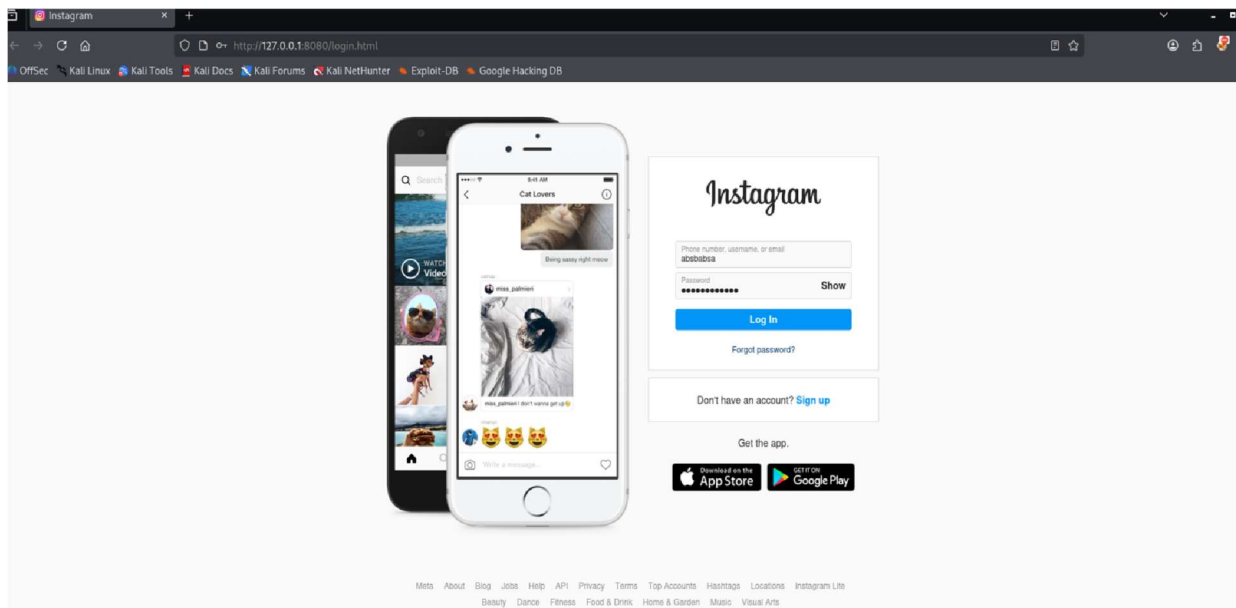


Figure 7.3. Simulation evidence screenshot 3.

```
[ - ] Waiting for Login Info, Ctrl + C to exit...  
[ - ] Victim IP Found !  
127.0.0.1's IP : 127.0.0.1  
[ - ] Saved in : auth/ip.txt  
[ - ] Victim IP Found !  
127.0.0.1's IP : 127.0.0.1  
[ - ] Saved in : auth/ip.txt  
[ - ] Victim IP Found !  
[ - ] Victim's IP : 127.0.0.1  
[ - ] Saved in : auth/ip.txt  
[ - ] Victim IP Found !  
[ - ] Victim's IP : 127.0.0.1  
[ - ] Saved in : auth/ip.txt  
[ - ] Login info Found !!  
[ - ] Account : absbabbsa  
[ - ] Password : saaaaaaaaaaaaa  
[ - ] Saved in : auth/usernames.dat  
[ - ] Waiting for Next Login Info, Ctrl + C to exit.  
[ - ] Victim IP Found !  
[ - ] Victim's IP : 127.0.0.1  
[ - ] Saved in : auth/ip.txt
```

Figure 7.4. Simulation evidence screenshot 4.

8. Tool Outputs

Representative defensive verification commands:

ss -lntp | grep ':8080' — Checks for a TCP listener on port 8080 and, where permitted, identifies the owning process.

netstat -tulpn | grep ':8080' — Alternative socket inspection command for verifying whether port 8080 remains bound.

ps aux | grep -E 'php|zphisher' — Can assist with identifying related processes in a controlled Linux lab.

Expected containment result: after the simulation process and web server are terminated, the socket inspection should return no matching listener for TCP port 8080.

9. Containment & Eradication

1. **Process Termination:** Terminated the simulation framework and associated PHP server on port 8080 to stop further credential capture.
2. **Artifact Removal:** Removed auth/ip.txt and auth/usernames.dat after reviewing the test evidence, reducing the risk of accidental disclosure.
3. **Session Invalidation:** Treated the test credential as exposed and performed password-reset/session-termination actions for the simulation account.
4. **Network Binding Isolation:** Verified that no leftover process remained bound to local TCP port 8080.

10. Mitigations

- **FIDO2 / WebAuthn:** Deploy phishing-resistant, origin-bound authentication so a password captured by a fraudulent site cannot be used as a substitute for a legitimate origin-bound authentication ceremony.
- **EDR / NDR Detection:** Detect unexpected web servers, suspicious PHP processes, login templates hosted on non-standard ports, unusual file creation containing authentication data, and process-to-socket correlations.
- **Phishing Awareness Training:** Train users to verify the complete domain, check HTTPS/TLS indicators, avoid suspicious links, and report unexpected authentication prompts.
- **Credential Protection:** Never store plaintext passwords in logs. Redact secrets from reports, restrict sensitive files, and use secure password-storage mechanisms.
- **Least Privilege:** Restrict who can launch local web services and security-testing frameworks on managed endpoints.
- **Incident Response:** Preserve relevant evidence, contain the service, reset exposed credentials, invalidate sessions, and verify that the listener and associated processes are gone.

11. Risk Assessment

Finding	Severity	Impact	Priority
Plaintext credential capture	High	Credential disclosure	Immediate
Unauthorized local login portal	High	User deception / credential theft	Immediate
Non-standard web listener	Medium	Unauthorized service exposure	High
Weak user URL verification	Medium	Phishing susceptibility	High

12. Conclusion

The phishing awareness simulation successfully demonstrates how a fraudulent authentication interface can generate detectable evidence and why layered defensive controls are necessary. The most useful detection approach

is correlation: authentication artifacts, file writes, process activity, and network listeners should be examined together. The exercise also shows that phishing-resistant MFA, endpoint/network monitoring, secure credential handling, and continuous user awareness can significantly reduce the risk associated with credential-harvesting attacks.

13. Reference Note

This report was prepared using the structure, terminology, and organization of the uploaded reference document, 'Vulnerability Assessment of Metasploitable2'. The reference uses sections including Rules of Engagement, Executive Summary, Tools & Methodology, Findings, Visuals, Mitigation, and Conclusion. Its embedded screenshots were included as reference visuals only; the phishing simulation findings in this report are based on the scenario supplied in the conversation.